I Made $200K in Two Years Working Blue-Collar Jobs

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 17, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/on5ckV6GCBM Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

During the 2008 recession — when unemployment hit record highs — Brandon Carter refused to go broke by stacking three blue-collar jobs simultaneously, earning $100K+ each year for two straight years.

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🗓️ The Weekday Grind 0:00

- Woke up at 4 AM every weekday
- Job 1 — Personal trainer: trained clients in the morning
  - Showered at the gym after sessions (no time to go home)
- Job 2 — Security guard: worked an 8-hour shift at the Prada store
- Job 3 — Moving company: worked immediately after the security shift
- Ran this three-job sequence **5 days a week**

🍖 Weekend Schedule 0:00

- Still woke up early on weekends
- Trained clients in the morning (same as weekdays)
- Then worked as **weekend manager at a barbecue restaurant in Queens**
- No days off described — weekends were fully booked

💰 Earnings & Economic Context 0:24

- Total earned: **over $200,000 across two years**
  - Each individual year exceeded $100,000
- All income came from blue-collar, "menial" jobs — no white-collar salary
- Time period: **the Great Recession of 2008**

    - Unemployment was at record highs nationally
    - People with master's degrees were working at Starbucks because hiring had frozen and layoffs were widespread

💪 Mindset: Refusing to Be Broke 0:24

- Did not view his situation as a victim of the economy
- Set a personal standard: *"I refused to be broke"*

> "It was a standard I set for myself. So I just worked nonstop."

- Solution was simple but brutal: volume of work, sustained over two full years
- No mention of side hustles, investing, or passive income — purely earned through labor and time